Wick Stove

Category: **Food Processing & Kitchen** Type: **Full SOP** Priority: **High** 2 labs

Covers these lab items: Wick Stove

What it is used for

A wick stove uses a fuel-soaked wick to produce a flame for cooking or heating. Operate it on a stable, ventilated surface with the correct fuel and keep it away from combustible materials to prevent fire, burns, and harmful fumes.

Main parts

- Stove body and fuel reservoir
- Wick and wick holder
- Wick-height adjustment knob
- Burner cover or flame control, if fitted
- Fuel filling opening and cap
- Stable base and supporting frame

Before you start

1. Confirm the stove type and use only the fuel specified by the manufacturer.
2. Inspect the fuel reservoir, wick, cap, seals, and stove body for damage or leakage.
3. Place the stove on a level, stable, non-combustible surface in a well-ventilated area.
4. Ensure curtains, paper, cooking oil containers, and other combustible items are kept away.
5. Check that the stove is cool and fully extinguished before refuelling.
6. Keep a suitable fire extinguisher or fire blanket accessible.

How to use

1. Ensure the stove is switched off and completely cool before filling.
2. Fill the reservoir with the specified fuel without overfilling or spilling.
3. Close the fuel cap securely and wipe away any spilled fuel before lighting.
4. Allow the wick to absorb fuel as directed by the manufacturer.
5. Adjust the wick to the recommended starting height.
6. Light the wick using a suitable long-reach lighter or approved lighting method.
7. Observe the flame and adjust the wick gradually to obtain a steady, controlled flame.
8. Place the cooking vessel centrally and ensure it is stable.
9. Monitor the flame continuously while cooking and keep children away.
10. Reduce the flame or extinguish it using the stove's approved control method when cooking is complete.
11. Confirm that the flame is completely out and allow the stove to cool before moving or cleaning it.

2. Clean the stove, check for leakage, and store fuel in an approved labelled container away from heat.

⚠ Safety

- Never refuel a hot or burning stove.
- Never use petrol or any fuel not approved for the stove.
- Do not use the stove in an enclosed or poorly ventilated room because of fire and carbon monoxide risks.
- Never leave a lit stove unattended or move it while burning.
- If fuel leaks, do not light the stove; keep ignition sources away and clean up safely.
- If a fire cannot be controlled immediately, evacuate and contact emergency services.

Care & storage

- Keep the wick trimmed and replace it when damaged or excessively worn, following the manual.
- Remove soot and food residue only after the stove has cooled completely.
- Inspect the reservoir, cap, seals, and fuel lines if fitted for leakage.
- Store the stove dry and keep fuel away from sunlight, flames, and heat sources.
- Arrange repair or replacement if the stove body, controls, or fuel system is damaged.

Common mistakes to avoid

- Refuelling before the stove has cooled completely.
- Using an incorrect fuel or overfilling the reservoir.
- Operating in a poorly ventilated space.
- Leaving the stove unattended or moving it while lit.

Disclaimer: This SOP is prepared from general information available on the internet. For detailed instructions, refer to the manufacturer's original manual / file.